

Getting started

From a fresh Windows computer to your first scan. Type each command into **PowerShell**: press Start, type PowerShell, press Enter. Copy one block at a time.

1. Install the tools (once)

SecureGate needs four free tools. **winget**, the app installer built into Windows, installs them:

```
winget install --id Git.Git -e
winget install --id Python.Python.3.12 -e
winget install --id Gitleaks.Gitleaks -e
winget install --id ezwinports.make -e
```

- **Git** keeps the history of a project.
- **Python** runs SecureGate.
- **Gitleaks** is the scanner that spots key-shaped text.
- **make** runs short commands such as `make setup`.

Close PowerShell and open it again, so that it finds the new tools. Then check them:

```
git --version
py -3.12 --version
gitleaks version
make --version
```

Each command prints a version number. If one says "not recognized", close PowerShell and open it once more.

2. Get SecureGate

```
cd $HOME\Documents
git clone <repository-address> SecureGate
cd SecureGate
```

Replace `<repository-address>` with the address your team gave you. `cd` means "change directory": it moves you into a folder.

The quick way on Windows: open the SecureGate folder in File Explorer and double-click `Start SecureGate.cmd`. The first time, it asks to set SecureGate up (step 3). Then SecureGate opens in its own window, with a menu. Type a number and press Enter:

- **1** scans the demo project, and builds it the first time (step 4). After the scan, press Enter to see the results in your browser (step 6), and press Enter again to close the dashboard.
- **2** scans a project of your own (step 5): type its folder, or drag the folder into the window.

- **3** opens the dashboard on the last scan, **4** shows the rules in `policy.yaml`, **5** builds the demo project again from scratch, and **6** checks the setup.
- **Q** closes SecureGate.

The menu runs the same commands as the steps below, and shows each one before it runs it. `make menu` opens the same menu from PowerShell, and on macOS and Linux.

3. Set it up (once)

```
make setup
```

This creates a private Python space called `.venv` inside the folder and installs SecureGate into it. It takes a minute or two.

4. Your first scan: the demo repo

```
make demo
make scan-demo
```

`make demo` builds a small fake payments app full of made-up secrets, in a folder called `securegate-demo` next to the SecureGate folder. `make scan-demo` scans it. You will see a table like this:

```
DECISION  RULE                FILE:LINE                VALUE
block     github-pat         .env:2                   ghp_****pVJI
block     aws-access-token   config/settings.py:11    AKIA****NOBM
block     private-key        deploy/server.key:1      -----****-----
...
11 findings: 6 block, 4 warn, 1 ignore -> BLOCKED (exit code 1). Details: findings-demo.json
make: *** [Makefile:47: scan-demo] Error 1
```

The last two lines are expected. The demo is full of secrets, so SecureGate blocks it (exit code 1), and `make` reports that as "Error 1". Every value is masked: SecureGate never shows a whole secret.

5. Scan a real project

Stay in the SecureGate folder, because it holds the rules, and point SecureGate at your project:

```
.venv\Scripts\securegate scan C:\path\to\your\project --mode repo
```

`--mode repo` reads the project's whole history. Other modes:

- `dir`: only the files as they are now.
- `staged`: only the changes you are about to commit.
- `range`: only some commits, for example `--mode range --range main..my-branch`.

To run all four scanners, add `--scanners all`. Install the other three first, once, with `make scanners`. TruffleHog reads the history too and can ask the provider whether a key it finds still works; Semgrep and Bandit check the code itself.

The first scan creates a `.securegate` folder holding a private key for fingerprints. Keep it. Git ignores it automatically.

6. See the results in your browser

```
make ui
```

This opens the dashboard on the demo scan at `http://127.0.0.1:5000`, a page only your own computer can open. Select a finding to see how to fix it. The buttons at the top download the findings as CSV (for Excel) or JSON, or open a report you can print or save as a PDF. Press Ctrl+C in PowerShell to stop the dashboard. For your own scan, use `.venv\Scripts\securegate ui --report findings.json --open`. More in Dashboard (ui.pdf).

7. Check every commit before it is made (once)

```
make hooks
```

This turns on the **laptop gate**: from now on, every `git commit` in this folder first scans the changes you are about to commit. If it finds a secret to block, the commit stops and shows the file and line, the masked value, why it was blocked and how to fix it. The first run of `make hooks` needs the internet; after that it works offline. More in The two gates (merge-gate.pdf).

On macOS or Linux

Install the same tools, then follow steps 2 to 7 in a terminal.

```
# macOS, with Homebrew (https://brew.sh):
brew install git python@3.12 gitleaks
xcode-select --install          # provides make

# Ubuntu or Debian Linux:
sudo apt install git make python3.12 python3.12-venv
# Gitleaks for Linux: https://github.com/gitleaks/gitleaks/releases
```

In steps 5 and 6, use `.venv/bin/securegate` instead of `.venv\Scripts\securegate`.